

WEEK 2: BUSINESS PROCESSES & STAKEHOLDER INVESTIGATION

From Enterprise Context & Business Functions to Effective Stakeholder Interviews

Course: Business Systems Analysis

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Faculty: Faculty of Technology

Week 2 Roadmap: From Context to Interview

01
Understand Enterprise

What does
company do?

02
Identify Functions

How is work
organized?

03
Identify Stakeholders

Who performs the
work?

04
Understand Processes

How does work
flow?

05
Interview Stakeholders
What actually
happens?

💡 **Core Principle: You cannot investigate a process effectively if you do not understand where it sits in the business.**

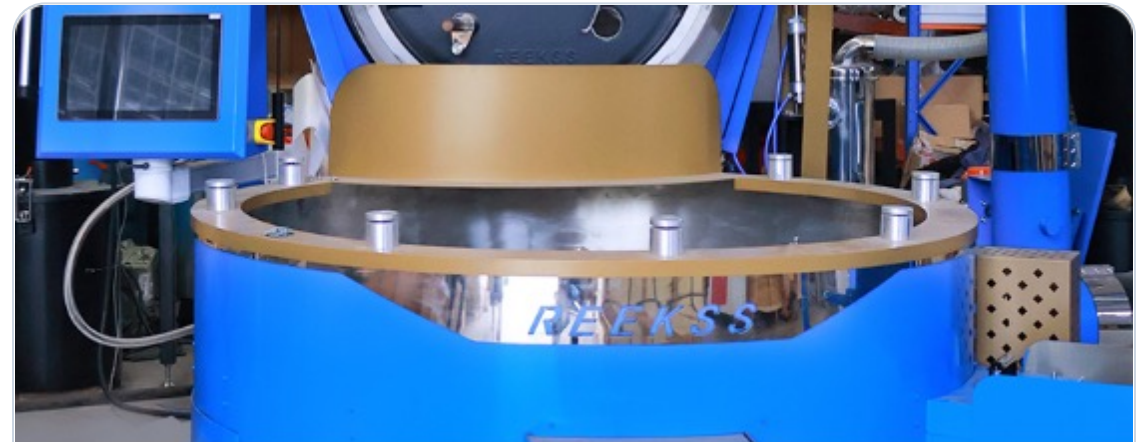
Why Do We Need Business Context?

✓ Essential Context Dimensions

- **What it sells:** Core products & services provided
- **Customers & Reach:** Who buys & sales channels
- **Operations:** Business locations & key functions

Key Takeaway

Business context gives meaning to everything we investigate later in the analysis process.



Example: Coffee Roasting Enterprise

Purchases raw beans → Roasts → Packages → Sells to customers. Context explains why Purchasing, Roasting, Inventory, Sales, and Accounting interact.

Week 1 Baseline vs. Week 2 Validation

Week 1 Baseline

Created initial Enterprise Profile & Investigation Plan.

Status: May still contain unverified assumptions.



Week 2 Validation

Validate and refine enterprise context before interviewing stakeholders.

Key Question: "Is our simulated enterprise context complete enough to support process investigation?"

Group Enterprise Setup (30-Minute Task)

A. Enterprise

- Business type
- Main products & services
- Customer segments
- Sales & delivery channels
- Operating locations

B. Organization

- Main business functions
- Key operational roles
- Functional relationships
- Reporting lines
- Handoff points

C. Investigation

- Primary focus areas
- Target stakeholders
- Processes to investigate
- Core assumptions
- Initial questions

What Must Be Clear Before Analysis?

WHAT

Offerings

What does company sell or provide?

WHO

Customers

Who are its main customers?

HOW

Delivery

How does it sell or deliver products?

WHERE

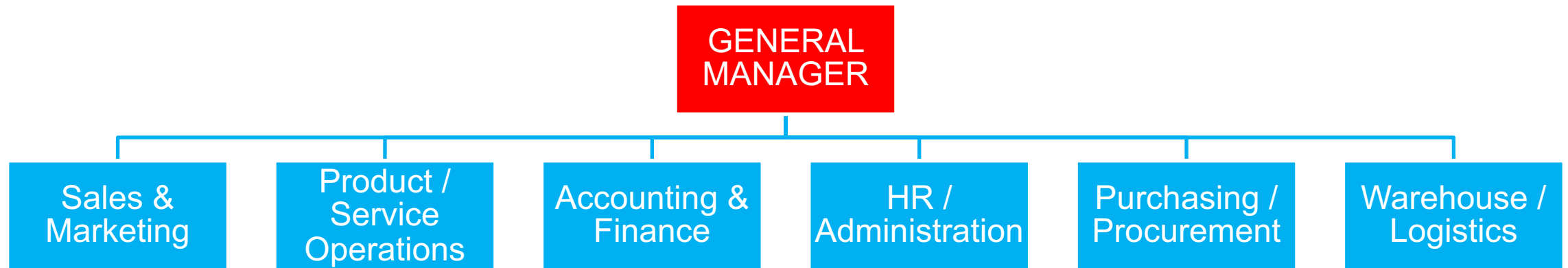
Operations

Where does business operate?



ORGANIZATION: What business functions are needed to operate the company?

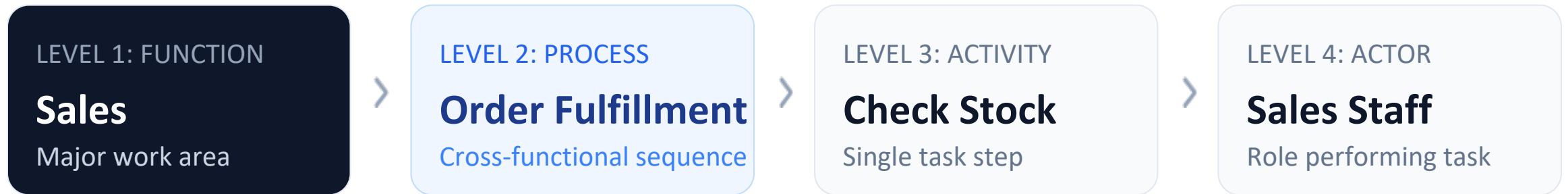
Basic Organizational Structure



Core Business Functions

Business Function	Main Purpose
Sales & Marketing	Attract customers and generate/manage sales orders.
Product / Operations	Create, prepare, or deliver the core product/service.
Accounting & Finance	Manage invoices, payments, and financial records.
HR & Administration	Manage personnel, facilities, and administrative duties.

Business Function ≠ Business Process



Important: Business functions organize work; business processes flow across functions to deliver customer value.

Common Setup Pitfalls to Check

✗ "We are an online store"

Fix: Too vague! Specify exact product categories and supply chain model.

✗ Missing Operations

Fix: Identify who creates, prepares, or packages the main product.

✗ "Sales handles everything"

Fix: Separate purchasing, inventory, delivery, and accounting roles.

✗ Automatic IT Department

Fix: IT is not automatically a core business function. Focus on core business.

Who Works Within Each Function?

Sales & Marketing

- Sales Manager
- Sales Staff

Operations

- Operations Manager
- Production Staff

Accounting

- Accountant
- Billing Clerk

Warehouse

- Warehouse Manager
- Warehouse Staff

Different Stakeholders See Different Parts

Example Process: Customer Order Fulfillment

Sales Staff

"I need to know whether I can confirm the order immediately."

Warehouse Keeper

"I need to know what items must be prepared and packaged."

Accountant

"I need the order details and customer payment record."

 **Conclusion: One interview is rarely enough to understand an entire cross-functional process.**

Now We Are Ready to Interview

Step 1: What the enterprise does

Step 2: What functions exist

Step 3: Who performs the work

Step 4: "How does this process actually work?"

Week 1 Materials to Use

- Primary Investigation Focus
- Primary Target Stakeholder
- 5–7 Initial Questions
- 2–3 Baseline Assumptions

Note: Questions are a starting point, not a rigid script.

What Should We Investigate?

WHO & WHAT

Who performs activity? What steps happen?

HOW & TOOLS

How is it done? What system/spreadsheet is used?

DATA & HANDOFF

What info is used? Who receives work next?

EXCEPTIONS

What happens when something goes wrong?

Ask → Listen → Probe → Confirm

1

ASK

"Walk me through order processing."

2

LISTEN

Record raw statements accurately.

3

PROBE

"What if stock is unavailable?"

4

CONFIRM

"So you message Warehouse first?"

AI Stakeholder Simulator



AI WILL Provide

Operational practices, manual handoffs, current tools, and daily exceptions.

AI WILL NOT Provide

Complete business analysis, root causes, or software solution requirements list.

Rule: Student investigates. Stakeholder responds.

AI Interview Practice (35-Minute Activity)

STEP 1 (5 min)

Review Materials

Review enterprise context, stakeholder role, focus area, and Week 1 questions.

STEP 2 (20 min)

Conduct Interview

Engage with AI Stakeholder Simulator using probing questions.

STEP 3 (10 min)

Evidence Log

Capture raw facts in the Interview Evidence Log.

Interview Evidence Log Structure

Stakeholder Role & Process

Information Used / Produced

Exceptions & Edge Cases

Confirmed / Revised Assumptions

Core Activities & Actors

Handoffs & Boundaries

Current Tools & Workarounds

Unresolved Follow-Up Questions

Week 2 Definition of Done

Enterprise Context

- ✓ Business type is clear
- ✓ Main products/services clear
- ✓ Customers & channels clear
- ✓ Core functions identified

Investigation

- ✓ Primary stakeholder known
- ✓ Target process selected
- ✓ Follow-up probes asked
- ✓ Evidence log completed